

Contract Approval Workflow

Owning area: Legal_Terms

Last reviewed: August 2026

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Policy owner: Director, Legal Operations

Applies to: IronStore entities and employees involved in creating, reviewing, approving, signing, or renewing contracts

1. Purpose and Overview

This workflow defines how IronStore contracts must be requested, reviewed, approved, signed, stored, and monitored. It is intended to ensure that contracts are commercially sound, legally compliant, accurately recorded, and approved by the appropriate budget and risk owners.

The workflow applies to supplier, logistics, technology, marketing, employment-related commercial, marketplace, consulting, real estate, and other business agreements. No employee may commit IronStore to contractual obligations outside this process.

Contracts must be handled through the designated systems and approval chains. Email approval alone is not sufficient unless specifically permitted under this document.

2. Scope

This workflow applies to:

- New contracts, statements of work, order forms, amendments, renewals, and termination agreements.
- Contracts with suppliers, service providers, brands, agencies, landlords, technology vendors, and business partners.
- Agreements involving IronStore entities in the EU, EEA, United Kingdom, or Switzerland.
- Contracts that process personal data, create intellectual property obligations, or involve customer-facing services.
- Purchases and commitments with a total expected value of **€5,000 or more**, including committed renewal periods.

The workflow does not replace specialist review required for:

- Employment contracts and employee relations matters.
- Product safety, customs, tax, or regulated product assessments.
- Information security assessments for technology or data-processing services.
- Real estate transactions or material financing arrangements.

Low-value purchases made through an approved catalogue or standard procurement channel may follow the simplified route in Section 5.

3. Policy Statement

All contracts must:

- Use an approved IronStore template or an approved counterparty template reviewed by Legal.
- Identify the correct IronStore contracting entity and authorised signatory.
- State pricing, currency, taxes, invoicing terms, service scope, and contract duration clearly.
- Include appropriate confidentiality, data protection, intellectual property, liability, termination, and governing-law provisions.
- Be stored in **IronStore ContractHub** before signature or, for urgent exceptions, within five business days after signature.
- Be approved before any purchase order, service commencement, public announcement, or supplier onboarding.

Employees must not:

- Sign contracts on behalf of IronStore unless listed in the Delegation of Authority Register.
 - Agree to side letters, verbal changes, or informal commitments that modify a signed contract.
 - Split a purchase into multiple documents to avoid an approval threshold.
 - Allow a supplier to begin work before the required approvals are complete.
 - Use personal email, local drives, or messaging applications as the official contract record.
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4. Contract Approval Procedure

4.1 Initiate the request

The business owner creates a contract request in **Coupa** and links it to the relevant purchase requisition, budget line, or project code.

The request must include:

- Counterparty legal name, registered address, and country.
- Contract type and short description of the service or goods.
- Estimated total value, including extensions, minimum commitments, and implementation fees.
- Proposed start date, end date, renewal mechanism, and notice period.
- Business owner, cost-centre owner, and expected signatory.

- Completed supplier due diligence status.
- Confirmation of whether personal data, customer data, or confidential information is involved.
- The proposed contract or commercial document.

The requestor is responsible for providing complete and accurate information. Incomplete requests may be returned without review.

4.2 Select the contract route

The requestor selects one of the following routes:

Standard route

Used for approved IronStore templates with no material changes and a value below €100,000. Procurement and the budget owner complete the commercial approval. Legal review is required for any deviation from the template.

Legal review route

Required where the counterparty uses its own terms, the contract contains non-standard risk, or the value is €100,000 or more. Legal reviews the agreement in **ContractHub** and records comments, issues, and approval status.

Enhanced review route

Required for:

- Personal-data processing or customer-data access.
- Critical technology, payment, fulfilment, or marketplace services.
- Exclusivity, minimum-volume commitments, or automatic renewal longer than 12 months.
- Unlimited liability, uncapped indemnities, or unusual insurance requirements.
- Intellectual property transfer, licence-back, or restrictions on IronStore content.
- Contracts with public-sector entities, sanctioned jurisdictions, or high-risk third parties.
- Total value above €1,000,000.

Enhanced review may require Privacy, Information Security, Finance, Tax, Compliance, or senior executive approval.

4.3 Commercial and legal review

Procurement reviews:

- Competitive sourcing or sole-source justification.
- Pricing, discounts, payment terms, and service credits.
- Supplier onboarding, bank details, and purchase-order requirements.
- Total cost over the full contractual term.

Legal reviews:

- Contracting entity, authority, and jurisdiction.
- Liability caps, indemnities, warranties, and remedies.
- Termination rights, renewal terms, and exit assistance.
- Confidentiality, intellectual property, and publicity rights.
- Data protection, security obligations, and subprocessor controls.
- Compliance with applicable EU and national law.

Where personal data is processed, the request must include a Data Processing Agreement or equivalent contractual terms. Privacy approval is required before signature.

Review comments must be resolved in ContractHub. The business owner must not accept legal or commercial changes by email without updating the contract record.

4.4 Approval thresholds

The following minimum approval chain applies to the total expected contract value:

- **Up to €25,000:** Budget owner and Procurement, where Procurement is involved.
- **€25,001–€100,000:** Budget owner, Procurement Manager, and business function director.
- **€100,001–€500,000:** Budget owner, Procurement Director, Finance Business Partner, and Legal.
- **€500,001–€1,000,000:** Above approvals plus VP or regional executive responsible for the function.
- **Over €1,000,000:** Above approvals plus CFO and General Counsel, or formally delegated equivalents.

Approval thresholds apply to the full term, including committed renewals, options, minimum spend, implementation charges, and termination fees. A contract with material legal risk may require a higher approval level regardless of value.

4.5 Sign-off and signature

After all approvals are recorded, the contract owner submits the final agreed version for signature through **DocuSign IronStore Enterprise**.

Before sending for signature, the requestor must confirm:

- The document is the final negotiated version.
- All schedules and attachments are included.
- The legal entity and signatory names are correct.
- The purchase order requirement is satisfied or formally waived.
- Required insurance, security, privacy, and supplier checks are complete.

Only authorised signatories listed in the Delegation of Authority Register may sign. Counterparty signatures must be obtained on the same version. If the counterparty requests changes after signature circulation begins, the document must return to the applicable review stage.

Electronic signatures are the default. Wet-ink signatures may be used where legally or operationally necessary, but the signed copy must still be uploaded to ContractHub.

4.6 Storage and obligation tracking

The contract owner uploads the fully executed agreement and all schedules to ContractHub within five business days of final signature.

The record must include:

- Contract number and linked Coupa request.
- Contracting entities and counterparty details.
- Effective date, expiry date, renewal date, and notice deadline.
- Total value, currency, payment terms, and cost centre.
- Business owner, Procurement owner, and Legal reviewer.
- Data-processing, security, insurance, and audit requirements.
- Key deliverables, service levels, credits, milestones, and termination rights.

ContractHub sends reminders 120, 90, and 30 days before expiry or notice deadlines. The business owner must review renewal proposals at least 60 days before the deadline and obtain approval for any extension.

5. Simplified and Urgent Processes

5.1 Low-value standard purchases

Purchases below €5,000 may use an approved catalogue, standard order form, or Coupa purchase order without separate Legal review when:

- No personal data is processed.
- The supplier uses IronStore standard terms or approved marketplace terms.
- There is no automatic renewal or minimum commitment.
- The purchase does not create material intellectual property, exclusivity, or liability exposure.

The purchase order and supporting documentation must remain in Coupa.

5.2 Urgent business needs

Urgent contracts may use expedited review only where delay would create a documented operational, customer, safety, or regulatory impact.

The business owner must:

- Mark the request as urgent in ContractHub.

- Explain the deadline and business impact.
- Obtain written approval from the function director.
- Involve Legal Operations and Procurement as early as possible.
- Complete all required approvals before signature.

Urgency does not permit an unauthorised employee to sign or remove mandatory data protection, security, compliance, or liability requirements. Any post-signature regularisation must be completed within five business days.

6. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Business owner:** Defines the business need, provides accurate information, manages performance, and monitors obligations.
 - **Requestor:** Creates the Coupa and ContractHub records and coordinates supporting documents.
 - **Procurement:** Leads sourcing, commercial negotiation, supplier onboarding, and purchase-order compliance.
 - **Legal:** Reviews legal terms, negotiates risk positions, approves deviations, and maintains this workflow.
 - **Privacy:** Reviews personal-data processing, data transfers, and Data Processing Agreements.
 - **Information Security:** Assesses technology, access, hosting, resilience, and security requirements.
 - **Finance:** Confirms budget, accounting treatment, payment terms, and financial exposure.
 - **Approving managers:** Confirm business need, value, risk acceptance, and budget authority.
 - **Authorised signatory:** Executes the final approved agreement for the correct IronStore entity.
 - **Legal Operations:** Maintains ContractHub records, reporting, reminders, and process controls.
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7. Related Documents and References

- **LEG-POL-006:** Delegation of Authority Register.
 - **LEG-STD-002:** IronStore Master Services Agreement.
 - **LEG-STD-005:** Supplier Terms and Conditions.
 - **PRIV-STD-003:** Data Processing Agreement.
 - **SEC-STD-011:** Third-Party Information Security Requirements.
 - **PROC-POL-004:** Supplier Due Diligence and Onboarding Policy.
 - **FIN-POL-009:** Purchase Order and Invoice Control Policy.
 - **IronStore ContractHub User Guide.**
 - **IronStore Records Retention Schedule.**
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8. Revision History

- **August 2026 — Version 3.0:** Added enhanced review route, ContractHub obligation reminders, and updated approval thresholds.
- **February 2025 — Version 2.2:** Clarified personal-data and Information Security review requirements.
- **October 2023 — Version 2.0:** Introduced Coupa intake and DocuSign Enterprise as standard workflow tools.